



Apply for Student's Pass

This facility allows registered foreign students to apply for a Student's Pass to study in the Institutes of Higher Learning (IHLs) in Singapore and update information on their issued Student's Pass such as Travel Document and Contact Information.

Valid Student's Pass holders, with SingPass account, can submit cancellation of their Student's Pass via this eService.

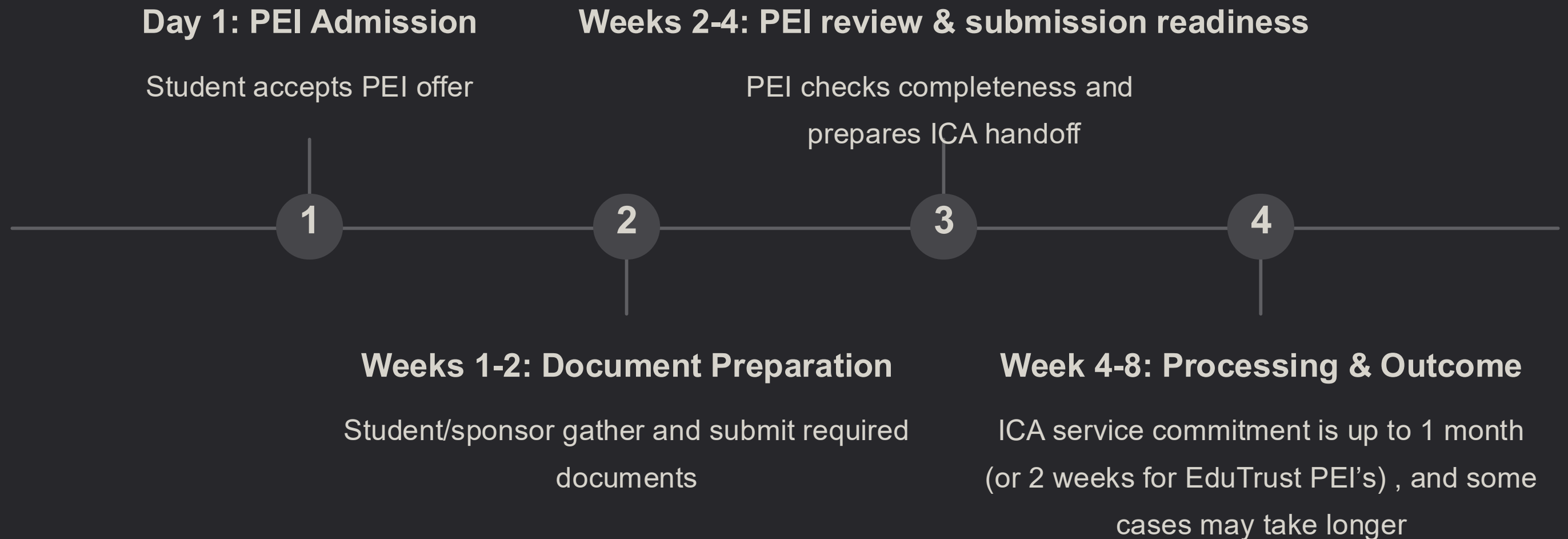
Information Required

- The Registration Acknowledgement Letter from the school
- Applicant's passport details
- Applicant's birth certificate (if applicable)
- Applicant's personal information, including the list of countries/places previously resided in, educational background, employment history and financial support
- Applicant's residential address, email address and contact details in Singapore
- Applicant's recent passport-sized colour photograph (taken within the last three months)
- VISA or Master Credit/Debit Card, American Express Card or Internet Banking Details.

New applications for a Student's Pass must be submitted at least one month and not more than two months before the commencement of the course. For more information on application of Student's Pass, please see [Frequently Asked Questions \(FAQs\)](#).



The Foreign Student's Journey

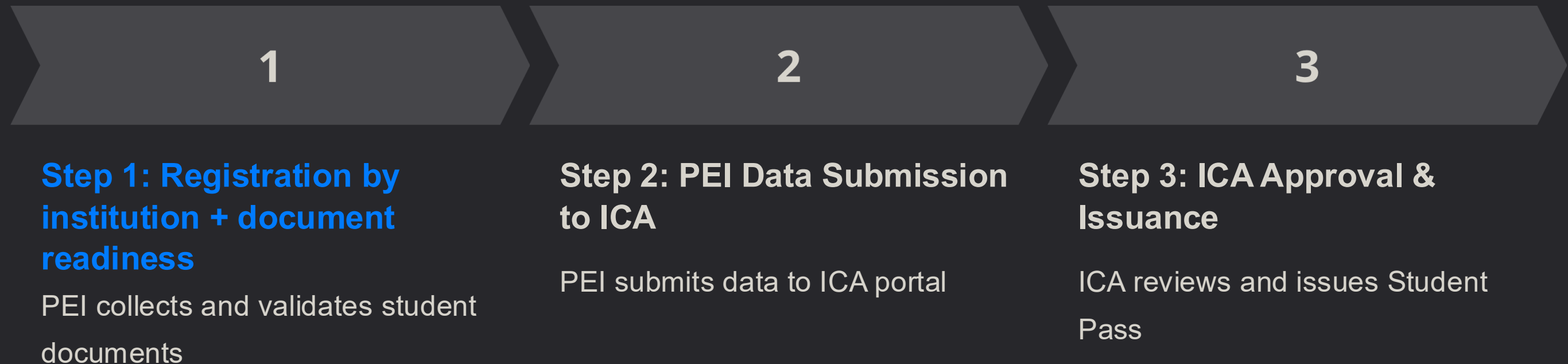


From 2017-2021, about **20% of PEI student pass were rejected(MHA)**. Rejections can lead to delays that cause students to miss intake timelines and lose opportunities

Current solution: SOLAR+

SOLAR+ is Singapore's new Student Pass system that shifted registration responsibility to PEIs.

This multi-step digital process begins with a critical initial phase:



The Real Problem: Step 1 (Registration by PEI)

Both students and institutions face significant challenges in the application process.

Student Pain Points



Uncertain processing timeline

ICA states some applications may take longer to process



Risk of delayed enrollment

For PEI cases, processing can be up to 1 month
(or 2 weeks for EduTrust-accredited PEIs)



Extra document requests

Additional supporting documents may be requested
During processing

PEI Administrative Burden



High follow-up load

Admin teams must chase students/sponsors when required documents are incomplete



Documentation risk

ICA states insufficient documentation may result in non-acceptance

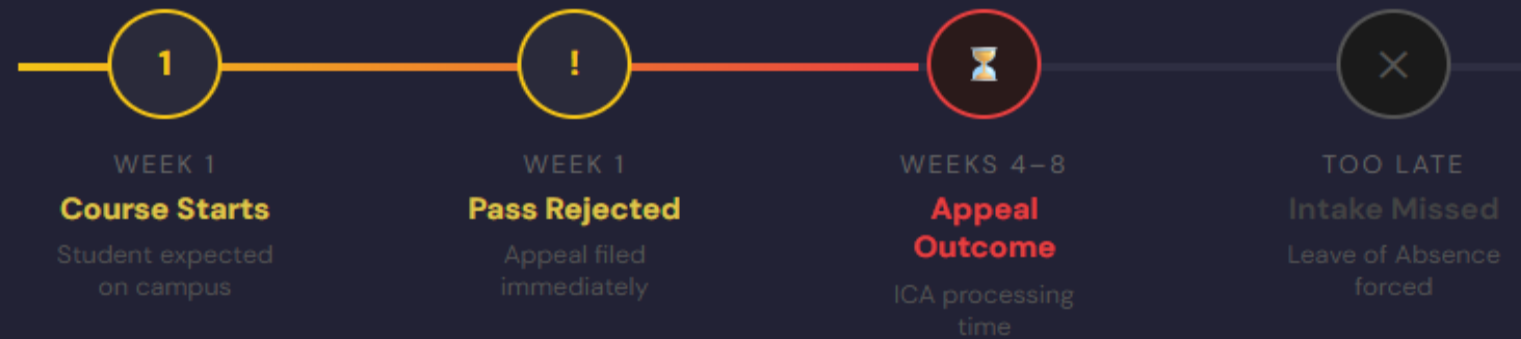


Late error discovery

Missing/inconsistent documents are often found only
At review stage, creating rework.

The core issue: Manual, fragmented processes create delays, errors, and lost opportunities for both students and institutions.

BY THE TIME THE APPEAL RESOLVES, THE SEMESTER HAS ALREADY BEGUN.



Result: Forced Leave of Absence

Student defers an entire semester. PEI loses one full intake of tuition fees — often tens of thousands of dollars per student.

"For unsuccessful appeal outcomes, students will have to go on Leave of Absence."

This isn't a worst-case scenario — it's the documented official fallback published by the institution itself.

Source: James Cook University Singapore — Official Student's Pass Application Guide

JCU's website

If Student's Pass Application is Rejected and you would like to appeal, please submit an appeal letter to Student Ambassador, with supporting documents within 7 working days.

An appeal application to ICA may take about 4-8 weeks for ICA to process. For unsuccessful appeal outcome, you will have to go on Leave of Absence by census date of the intake. Please ensure that you have a valid pass in Singapore during the appeal process.

Key insights

These aren't edge cases; missing documents and admin errors are the #1 documented cause of Student Pass rejections at PEIs.

Ministry of Home affairs

Mr K Shanmugam, Minister for Home Affairs and Minister for Law:

1. From 2017 to 2021, the Immigration & Checkpoints Authority (ICA) received annually, an average of 52,700 applications for Student's Pass (STP) to study in private schools. A large majority – about 80% – were successful, while about 20% were rejected.
2. Securing a place in a school does not and cannot guarantee STP approval. ICA assesses each STP application holistically, and on its individual merits. For example, an applicant could be rejected because he has adverse records, or is unable to show that he has the ability to financially support himself for the duration of the course.

Crystal W – student from Hong Kong

I was accepted by the school this January and my school helps me to apply the student pass in October.
Yet, my application is rejected without reason, received in 2 weeks.

So my school and I decided to appeal again, with school sending the appeal letter, and I sending

Reddit post



r/askSingapore • 7mo ago
rolling_catfish2704

Is the time to process my student pass really this long?

I have been waiting since earlier this month for my health checkup documents to be processed, and the website said they'll process it in 7 days. I've been checking every day for an update to pay and complete my formalities. Its been a few weeks since and Im starting to wonder if they even give a shit about what I sent. Im worried I wont be able to get a bank account, so please help!

0 3

Singapore expat forum

Student pass application rejected

by **Vijay Thangraj** » Fri, 24 Feb 2012 12:09 am

My sad student visa rejection story

1. this college applied to ICA for my student pass but with mistakes in my previous qualification name and without any bank statement. They never told me ICA would need bank records

Problem Statement

PEIs in Singapore undergo a fragmented and manual pre-submission workflow for Student's Passes (registration-by-institution), where staff are required to chase missing documents, re-enter data across systems, and lack real-time visibility on case readiness. This in turn causes avoidable delays, higher risk of documentation-related rejections, and even loss of missed intake revenue.

Market Context & Stakeholders

→ **Market Size**

- Singapore has >300 Private Education Institutions (PEIs)
- By 2027, 75–80% of PEI students will be international students

→ **Target user: PEI**

PEIs are responsible for preparing and submitting Student Pass applications through the SOLAR+ system.

→ **Secondary Beneficiary: Immigration & Checkpoints Authority (ICA)**

Cleaner and more complete submissions help reduce correction cycles and improve processing efficiency.

Value proposition for PEI



Operational Efficiency

- Reduce weekly admin handling time per case
- Minimize repetitive manual follow up with students/sponsors
- Replace fragmented email coordination with a structured workflow



Submission Quality

- Detect missing or inconsistent documents before ICA handoff
- Reduce incomplete submissions
- Standardize internal review decisions across admin teams



Intake & Revenue stability

- Increase likelihood of students meeting intake timelines
- Reduce risk of delayed enrollments and tuition leakage
- Improve student confidence through clearer process visibility

Introducing B.o.B: The Solution

Built on Apply.sg's existing platform

- **SOLAR+ Prefill lookup (API/Webhook)**
Autofills known student/application fields from SOLAR+ reference number
- **Guided student/sponsor document collection**
Student and sponsor documents collected in one structured workflow
- **AI document Intelligence**
Checks identity, passport validity, photo compliance, education and financial sufficiency
- **Rejection risk scoring(0-100)**
Converts AI check outcomes into a transparent risk score for admin decisions
- **Admin decision gate before ICA handoff**
Approve as “ready for ICA submission” or return for corrections with reasons/comments

Before vs. After B.o.B: step 1 (registration by PEI)

How PEI moves from manual coordination to submission ready cases

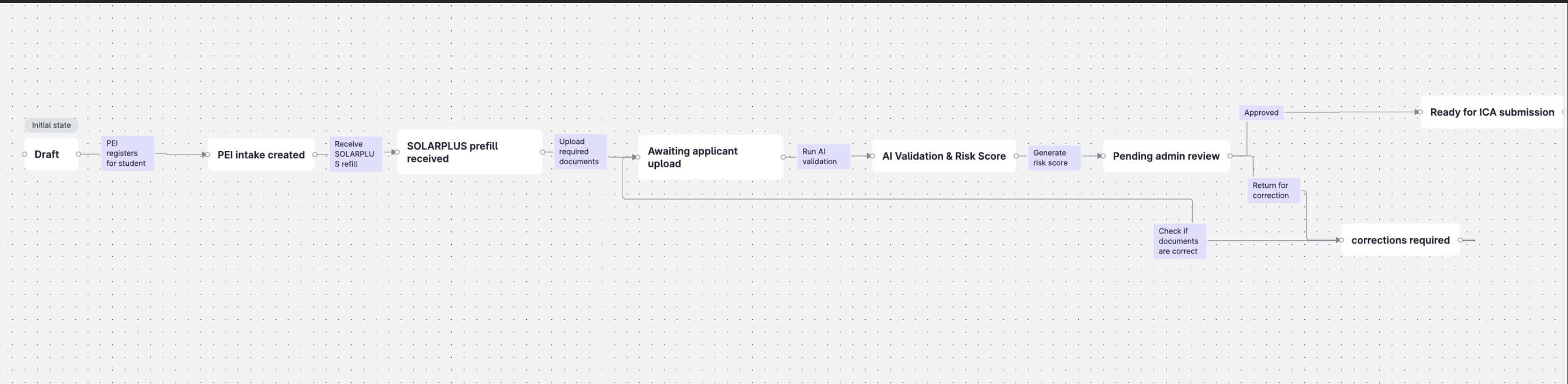
BEFORE: Fragmented registration

-  Student/sponsor documents scattered across emails
-  Admin manually checks each file
-  Manual duplicate data entry causes errors and inconsistencies
-  Back-and-forth emails for missing docs

AFTER: Structured readiness workflow

-  Single case workflow for PEI, student and sponsor
-  SOLAR+ prefill lookup reduces manual entry
-  AI document intelligence checks consistency early
-  Rejection risk score supports admin decision
-  Registration ready for ICA submission
-  Estimated 1-2 weeks internal PEI readiness

Workflow for PEI registration



Case Details

SOLAR+ Application Number

PN-1234-000029487

Intake created date

08 Mar 2026

Intended intake month (PEI matriculation)

April

Programme admitted

Student Details

Student Full Name

Alice Tan Zhe Xuan

Student Email

ATZX@ntu.edu.sg

Passport Number

A123456G

Nationality

Indonesia

Date of Birth

17 May 2006

PEI intake & Registration setup

Sponsorship

Sponsor Required?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No

Institution Documents

Offer Letter

Drag and drop files here or [select files](#)

Supported file types: jpg, png, gif, pdf, doc, docx, ppt, pptx, xls, xlsx, zip

SOLAR+ Application Number

PN-1234-000029487

Student Email

ATZX@ntu.edu.sg

SOLAR+ Prefill Lookup

Retrieve

Last retrieved: -

Student Name

Prefilled

Alice Tan Zhe Xuan

Passport number

Prefilled

A123456G

Programme Admitted

Prefilled

Bachelor of psychological Science(Honours)

SOLAR+ Prefill via API
lookup

Student Documents

Passport Bio Page

Proof of passport details to verify name, passport no., nationality, DOB, expiry.

Drag and drop files here or [select files](#)

Supported file types: jpg, png, gif, pdf, doc, docx, ppt, pptx, xls, xlsx, zip

Upload up to 10 files. Each file must be 10MB or less.

Passport style photo

Upload a recent passport-style photo (plain background, clear image, no filters/headwear unless required). PDF/JPG/PNG only

Drag and drop files here or [select files](#)

Supported file types: jpg, png, gif, pdf, doc, docx, ppt, pptx, xls, xlsx, zip

Upload up to 10 files. Each file must be 10MB or less.

Highest Education Certificate

Drag and drop files here or [select files](#)

Supported file types: jpg, png, gif, pdf, doc, docx, ppt, pptx, xls, xlsx, zip

Upload up to 10 files. Each file must be 10MB or less.

☒ I declare that the information and documents submitted above are legitimate and complete, and I consent to their use for the Student P: processing.

Student and sponsor document collection

Sponsor Documents

Sponsor required?

- ☒ Yes
- ☐ No

Sponsor Full Name

Tan Meng Wee

Sponsor Relationship

Uncle

Sponsor Email

TMW@gmail.com

Sponsor Financial Support Proof

Sponsor to upload proof that he/she can financially support the student (e.g., recent bank statement, income proof etc.)

Drag and drop files here or [select files](#)

Supported file types: jpg, png, gif, pdf, doc, docx, ppt, pptx, xls, xlsx, zip

Upload up to 10 files. Each file must be 10MB or less.

☒ I declare that I am willing and financially capable to sponsor the student, and that all information/documents submitted are legitimate and accurate.

AI Document Intelligence

AI checks document content and consistency first. Outputs are then used to generate the rejection risk score before admin review

Identity Match Check
Name, DOB, nationality, passport number to match across fields/docs.

Pass

✕

▼

Passport Validity Check
Expiry date meets minimum validity window.

Pass

✕

▼

Photo Compliance Check
Format/spec compliance + quality meets standards

Fail

✕

▼

Financial Sufficiency Check
Sponsor/student funds meet threshold and document recency requirement.

Fail

✕

▼

Rejection Risk scoring

Risk score is derived from AI check outcomes to support PEI review decisions.

Identity Risk Score

0

Passport Risk Score

0

Photo Risk Score

20

AI Validation & Rejection Risk Scoring

Risk Score

Risk Score

Score(0-100)
from AI document checks (0-100). Higher score indicates higher rejection risk.

Admin Review

Decision Review

- ☐ Approved (Ready for ICA Submission)
- ☒ Return for Corrections

Reasons for return

Missing document × Invalid photo ×

Reviewer comments

What exactly was missing/invalid and what exactly should be provided

Photo Unclear and Highest Education Certificate not included

Admin Review Decision Gate

Admin Review

Decision Review

- ☒ Approved (Ready for ICA Submission)
- ☐ Return for Corrections

Reasons for return

Click to select

Reviewer comments

What exactly was missing/invalid and what exactly should be provided

Success Metrics: How We Measure Impact

2-3

Time to Approval (weeks)

Our North Star Metric

95%+

Application Completion Rate

<2%

Rejection Rate

Pricing Strategy

\$5

per application

A simple processing fee paid directly by the student.

Zero Cost for PEIs

Institutions pay nothing to use our platform.

Scaling Beyond Student Passes

Our proven architecture resolves complex, document-heavy workflows across diverse industries.
We can eliminate bottlenecks that occurs from the same **three-party problems**.



Work Pass & Employment Visa

Employer + Foreign Hire + MOM



Financial Services

Bank + Applicant +
Employer/Guarantor



PR & citizenship application

Law Firm + Applicant + ICA

The Complete Picture



The Problem

Manual, fragmented processes.
Leading to lost revenue & time



The Solution

B.o.B automates document
collection & validation.



Business Model

\$5 per application, hidden in
processing fee.



Impact

1-2 weeks to approval, <2% rejection rate.



Vision

Scalable to other document-heavy flows.

Thank You